Alluvial ridge construction and channel–floodplain connectivity: an independent numerical reconstruction

Independent implementation of the written model specification of Nicholas et al. (2018)

October 9, 2026

Abstract

The balance between channel bed aggradation and overbank deposition controls channel depth and the pathways by which water reaches a floodplain. Nicholas et al. [1] used this balance to relate alluvial ridge relief to channel–floodplain connectivity over 580 repeated floods. This report documents an independent reconstruction from the paper and its written supplement. It records the physical specification, numerical assumptions, verification evidence, and the status of all 13 manuscript panels. Numerical panels must be generated from saved output of this implementation; published curves and raster values are not model or plotting inputs. The current completion status and remaining limitations are reported explicitly below.

1 Scope and current evidence

The calculation tests whether a coupled one-dimensional channel and two-dimensional floodplain model yields the spatial and temporal behavior reported by Nicholas et al. [1]. Their calculations describe the period preceding an avulsion. Neither their prescribed channel migration model nor the reconstruction should be interpreted as a prediction of an avulsion occurrence or recurrence interval.

The permitted scientific inputs are published descriptions and configuration values. The authors' original implementation, simulation files, plotting scripts, and source data are excluded. Published figures were inspected for comparison, without digitization. Published values in the supplement's results columns are not substitutes for computed values. No published figure is embedded in this report. There are no supplementary figures in GSA Data Repository 2018219; DR1 is a written model description and DR2 is a parameter and results table [2].

Current panel ledger: 13 not reproduced. Panels marked partial or not reproduced have missing outputs or agreement limits described in the ledger. Rebuild execution is recorded separately. This report merges the maintained scientific ledger with current plotted-data coverage. Complete numerical coverage alone is classified as partial until a scientific assessment is documented. Source-ledger notes are retained as prior documentation, and current coverage and input provenance are listed separately for every panel.

2 Physical specification

We model a floodplain that is 48 km wide and 72 km long. The documented grid spacing is 250 m, giving 192 by 288 cells. The initial floodplain is planar with downstream slope 10^{-4}. We set its initial elevation to $z_0(x) = 10^{-4}(72\,000\,\mathrm{m} - x)$, where x increases downstream from the inlet. This vertical

datum is an implementation convention. The initially straight channel has width $B = 500$ m and depth 8 m. A flood lasts $T_f = 20$ days and has minimum and peak discharges of 2,500 and 15,000 $\mathrm{m^3\ s^{-1}}$. Each configuration requires 580 floods with the same hydrograph. These values are specified by DR1 [2]; the hydrograph shape is not specified there.

The channel bed rises by a prescribed increment A after each flood. At any given flood it has constant slope in channel arc length s. For a channel of length L_c, the slope is $7.2\,\mathrm{m}/L_c$, so the inlet–outlet bed elevation drop remains 7.2 m as sinuosity changes. For flood index $n \geq 1$, the bed during the hydrograph is

$$z_c(s, n) = z^0_{c,\mathrm{in}} + (n-1)A - 7.2\,\mathrm{m}\frac{s}{L_c(n)}, \tag{1}$$

where $z^0_{c,\mathrm{in}} = -0.8$ m and $L_c(n)$ is the channel length during flood n. Saved rasters, channel coordinates, and end-flood diagnostics precede that flood's migration, cutoff, and bed increment. Thus a raster labeled flood n contains $(n-1)A$ of imposed bed rise. The restart checkpoint follows migration and the nth increment. Equation (1) imposes bed elevation independently of suspended sediment exchange; it does not predict bedload transport.

The inlet concentration follows $S = CQ^{1.5}$. The supplement does not state units for S or C. Any conversion to SI concentration must be identified as an assumption. The default grain fractions are 5% sand, 75% silt, and 20% clay; the fine mixture is 5% sand, 20% silt, and 75% clay. The bank erodibility multiplier E is usually 1, with selected values of 0.5 and 1.5. Appendix B lists all 31 configurations.

2.1 Conservation laws and coupling

The written specification requires depth-averaged shallow-water flow and three suspended sediment fractions. In a floodplain cell, let h be water depth, $\mathbf{u} = (u, v)$ velocity, z bed elevation, and c_k the suspended mass concentration for grain class k. Away from external boundaries, the governing balances have the form

$$\partial_t h + \nabla \cdot (h\mathbf{u}) = 0, \tag{2}$$

$$\partial_t(h\mathbf{u}) + \nabla \cdot \left(h\mathbf{u} \otimes \mathbf{u} + \tfrac{1}{2}gh^2\mathbf{I}\right) = -gh\nabla z - \mathbf{f}_b + \nabla \cdot \mathbf{T}, \tag{3}$$

$$\partial_t(hc_k) + \nabla \cdot (h\mathbf{u}c_k) = \nabla \cdot (hD_k\nabla c_k) - d_k. \tag{4}$$

Here $\mathbf{f}_b$ is bed resistance per unit water density, $\mathbf{T}$ represents any chosen horizontal momentum diffusion, D_k is sediment diffusivity, and d_k is deposition per unit bed area and time. The written sources determine the required transport structure; the final constitutive choices and any omitted terms must be stated in the implementation record below. If concentration is in $\mathrm{kg\ m^{-3}}$, d_k is in $\mathrm{kg\ m^{-2}\ s^{-1}}$. Deposit thickness is related to deposited mass by

$$\partial_t z = \frac{\sum_k d_k}{\rho_s(1-p)}, \tag{5}$$

where ρ_s is sediment density and p is deposit porosity. Equation (5) applies to the modeled depositional bed changes, not to the separately prescribed channel aggradation.

The channel uses section-integrated water and momentum equations and advection–diffusion of three suspended fractions, with lateral exchange and boundary supply. Net exchange between channel suspension and its prescribed bed is set to zero. Channel aggradation and geometry adjustments are independent signed bed forcing, recorded separately in the solid-mass budget. DR1 prescribes the bed and excludes bedload-based updates, but does not establish zero net exchange with suspension [2]. This is therefore a physical assumption, not a recovered closure. Channel variables are interpolated to

floodplain-grid cells within $B/2$ of the centerline, with velocity rotated into the local channel tangent. Interface face fluxes update the floodplain and the corresponding channel section with equal and opposite water and sediment mass transfers. The overlaid channel cells must not duplicate the water or sediment storage already represented by the one-dimensional channel.

At the end of each flood, the written specification calls for Howard–Knutson migration with neck cutoffs [3]. Newly occupied channel cells are lowered to the interpolated channel bed. Their eroded sediment is returned at the upstream concentration boundary. The timing, grain allocation, and mass accounting for this return are implementation choices where DR1 is incomplete. The topography of abandoned channel cells, cutoff handling, and remapping of water and sediment also require explicit choices. A migration displacement is not itself a shallow-water avulsion.

2.2 Implementation and unresolved assumptions

The computational model is C++17. It uses the specified 250 m floodplain grid and rectangular channel sections at approximately 250 m spacing. The channel mask consists of grid centers within 250 m of the centerline. The nearest segment gives linear interpolation weights, which are also used for incoming exchange. An outgoing mass is removed in proportion to each section's contribution to the interpolated donor inventory; this prevents withdrawal from an empty section. The channel's exact rectangular control areas replace masked floodplain storage. The raster bed inventory and the rectangular water storage consequently have slightly different footprints.

We inherit channel and floodplain Chezy coefficients of 55 and 10 $\mathrm{m}^{1/2}\ \mathrm{s}^{-1}$ from Nicholas et al. (2013) [5]. Let C_h denote this coefficient, distinct from sediment coefficient C. The resistance and eddy viscosity are

$$\mathbf{f}_b = \frac{g}{C_h^2}\mathbf{u}|\mathbf{u}|, \qquad u_* = \frac{\sqrt{g}}{C_h}|\mathbf{u}|, \qquad \nu_t = 0.07 u_* h. \tag{6}$$

The symmetric velocity-gradient tensor gives horizontal turbulent stress; we set sediment diffusivity equal to ν_t, an assumed Schmidt number of one. A local friction update follows each transport substep.

We assume that S is in mg L^{-1}, consistent with concentration units reported in the 2013 methods paper, so internal inlet concentration is $10^{-3} C Q^{3/2}$ kg m^{-3}. At the peak discharge, $C = 0.003$ gives 5.511 kg m^{-3}. The 2018 paper does not establish this unit convention. Porosity 0.4 and grain density 2650 kg m^{-3} are assumed. Sand settles at 0.023244 m s^{-1}, calculated from the Ferguson–Church relation [6] for assumed 0.2 mm particles. Silt uses 0.0002 m s^{-1} from the earlier methods paper. Clay uses Stokes settling for assumed unflocculated 2 μm spheres, giving 3.597×10^{-6} m s^{-1}. For silt and clay, the deposition sink is

$$d_k = w_{s,k} c_k \max(0, 1 - \tau_b/\tau_c), \qquad \tau_b = \rho_w g |\mathbf{u}|^2 / C_h^2, \tag{7}$$

with assumed $\tau_c = 0.1$ Pa. Sand deposition is independent of this shear reduction. At fixed depth and stress, deposition integrates exponentially, and the removed suspended mass increments bed elevation exactly once. Vertical floodplain entrainment is omitted because the earlier sand-capacity-based closure does not close the three-fraction, prescribed-channel-bed problem. This omission is a physical uncertainty.

The floodplain is initially dry. The channel starts at the minimum-discharge normal depth, 4.356 m, with zero suspended concentration. The unreported hydrograph shape is taken as

$$Q(t) = 2500 + 12500 \sin^2(\pi t / T_f) \quad \mathrm{m}^3\,\mathrm{s}^{-1}. \tag{8}$$

Water and sediment fields persist between floods. At the inlet we prescribe Q and preserve the outgoing shallow-water characteristic $u - 2\sqrt{gh}$. At the subcritical outlet we preserve $u + 2\sqrt{gh}$ and impose the

Chezy normal-flow rating for the current channel slope. These boundary conditions are assumptions. Unsupported incoming supercritical states stop the calculation with an explicit error. Floodplain lateral and upstream boundaries reflect flow; the downstream boundary is transmissive with continued valley slope.

Floodplain transport rates are evaluated once per macro step, with CFL coefficient 0.4, a 120 s ceiling, and positive-inventory restrictions. The channel takes additional wave-limited substeps with fixed lateral exchange rates during that interval. The scheme is first order in time. Both representations receive identical integrated water and sediment exchange; channel momentum exchange includes the advective streamwise component. Side pressure is normal to the physical streamline and is not added as a streamwise force from raster stair steps. Exactly dry regions are skipped computationally without changing active-state arithmetic.

Migration uses the linear-curvature Howard–Knutson/Ikeda parameterization written in later methods descriptions [7, 8]. For curvature κ, define

$$R_0 = k_l B \kappa, \qquad R_1 = E\left[-R_0 + 2.5\frac{\int_0^s R_0(\xi) e^{-a(s-\xi)}\, d\xi}{\int_0^s e^{-a(s-\xi)}\, d\xi}\right], \quad a = \frac{2g}{C_h^2 H}. \tag{9}$$

We use assumed $k_l = 400$ m per flood, bankfull depth H, fixed endpoints, and 5 m initial random perturbations with seed 2018. Here k_l is the coefficient per unit dimensionless curvature, not the mean observed migration speed. The upstream integral is exact for piecewise-linear curvature. Adaptive steps and geometric resampling control numerical crowding. Nonadjacent limbs closer than one channel width form a neck cutoff. The precise 2018 migration parameterization is unverified.

Migration precedes prescribed aggradation. Newly cut cells are excavated to the pre-aggradation channel bed; abandoned cells retain their former bed. Eroded dry mass enters a reservoir and is returned at the next inlet with the selected grain fractions and a $Q^{3/2}$ concentration shape. Release is limited by available reservoir inventory, with quadrature remainders carried forward. Conservative overlap in normalized arc length remaps channel state; changes in masked raster storage are transferred between the channel and floodplain. The redistribution after migration and fixed bank grain fractions are explicit assumptions. Prescribed bed changes have a separate signed sediment source in the mass ledger. A nonpositive bankfull depth is treated as a failure of the prescribed channel geometry, not replaced by an artificial minimum.

For α, the floodplain depth average includes dry cells. A bank face is inundated when floodplain water and channel overtopping both exceed 1 mm; this threshold affects diagnostics only. No wet interface gives an undefined value. The immediate active-channel interface is consistent with visual inspection of published Figure 1E, although the raster implementation and wetness criterion are assumptions. Ridge relief for β uses the maximum transverse value of longitudinal-mean relief over the central 80% of the reach, relative to the outermost 10% lateral bands. Channel depth is the bank-face mean elevation minus adjacent channel bed. We average the resulting β_n over floods 561–580. These averaging choices are not specified in DR1.

The horizontal Boussinesq turbulent stress is implemented, but the secondary-flow and associated dispersive terms in the earlier methods paper are omitted [5]. These terms describe effects of unresolved vertical velocity structure; horizontal eddy viscosity does not replace them. Bed composition is also not tracked as deposits accumulate and are reworked. Excavated bank mass is assigned the selected inlet grain fractions. This preserves total solid mass while losing the grain identity of earlier deposits. Together with omitted vertical floodplain entrainment and zero net channel suspended-bed exchange, these choices limit correspondence with the inherited process equations.

DR1 specifies first-order spatial accuracy and an explicit finite-volume approximate Riemann solver.

The independent kernel uses hydrostatic reconstruction [4]. At an interface, $z_* = \max(z_L, z_R)$ and $h_* = \max(0, h + z - z_*)$. Velocities and concentrations are retained in the reconstructed wet states. Side-specific pressure corrections balance a stationary free surface over bed steps. The HLL water flux and the sediment flux formed from upwind concentration are shared between the two sides. These are independently selected numerical details, not a claim to match the original implementation.

3 Diagnostics and verification

The published super-elevation ratio is

$$\beta_n = \frac{z_{\mathrm{ridge},n} - z_{\mathrm{distal},n}}{H_{\mathrm{channel},n}}. \tag{10}$$

The reported late-time statistic is the arithmetic mean of the 20 per-flood ratios β_n at floods 561–580. Ridge relief is the maximum transverse value of longitudinal-mean relief over the central 80% of the reach, relative to the outermost 10% lateral bands. Channel depth is the mean bank-face elevation minus adjacent channel-bed elevation. These spatial averages and the mean-of-ratios convention are implementation choices not resolved by the supplement. A constant vertical datum cancels from the numerator, but changes in the selected ridge or distal region do not.

For each flood, the connectivity measure is sampled at $t = 0.6T_f = 12$ days:

$$\alpha_n = \frac{\overline{h}_{\mathrm{fp},n}}{f_{\mathrm{wet},n}}, \qquad \alpha_{95} = P_{95}\{\alpha_{381}, \ldots, \alpha_{580}\}. \tag{11}$$

Here f_{wet} is the inundated fraction of the channel–floodplain interface. Unlike β, α has units of meters. The depth average includes every floodplain cell, including dry cells. The interface consists of internal Cartesian faces between active channel and floodplain cells; all faces have equal length at the uniform grid spacing. A face is inundated when floodplain depth and channel overtopping depth both exceed 1 mm. Zero inundated fraction gives undefined α. The percentile uses linear interpolation and requires all 200 values to be finite; missing or undefined values are neither replaced by zero nor discarded.

At day 12 the output retains α, mean floodplain depth, and inundated interface fraction, but no raster fields. The saved rasters are from flood end, so day-12 inundated area and the locations of active breaches cannot be reconstructed from these outputs. The channel geometry is unchanged within each hydrograph; its end-flood outline therefore identifies the full day-12 interface, without identifying the inundated subset.

Verification must distinguish discrete conservation from agreement with the paper. Required checks include a lake at rest, positive wetting and drying, coupled water and grain-mass exchange, analytical transport and settling, zero forcing limits, and cutoff/remapping budgets. External boundary fluxes, bed changes, and prescribed channel aggradation must be reported separately. Representative coupled cases require grid and time step sensitivity. Kernel tests alone cannot establish these properties for the full coupled model.

Component and coupled tests pass in the current development build. The lake-at-rest kernel error is 6.76×10^{-15} after 1000 steps. Analytical settling conserves suspended plus deposited mass, and periodic sediment diffusion errors decrease from 1.04×10^{-5} to 3.04×10^{-6} to 7.61×10^{-7} under successive refinement. Migration tests verify curvature, the upstream convolution, symmetry, cutoff length accounting, and finite evolution over 580 migration steps. These are tests of the migration component, not 580 coupled flood runs.

Coupled tests verify reflecting boundaries, two-way class and water exchange, remapping with and without aggradation, and the complete suspension–bed–bank-reservoir ledger. A localized suspended plume remains nonnegative through 150 macro steps. Its water and sediment budget residuals are approximately 4×10^{-9} m^3 and 4×10^{-11} kg. A steady normal-channel test has maximum relative depth errors 0.179% and 0.0843% at 250 and 125 m section spacing. The imposed reservoir-release waveform error decreases from 0.004915 to 0.002461 when the CFL coefficient is halved. Positive integration remainders remain in the reservoir; injected plus remaining mass is conserved.

A two-flood short-domain checkpoint test reproduces uninterrupted raster output, channel coordinates, and the final checkpoint byte-for-byte. Changed checkpoint parameters are rejected, and diagnostic rows written after the last valid checkpoint are regenerated. These checks establish restart behavior for the tested case.

The first full-domain, 20-day flood and representative floodplain-grid and time-step refinement calculations are still running. Their results are not yet available, and the component tests do not establish grid independence or long-term quantitative agreement for the 31 production configurations. Exact commands and logs are in `validation/` and `docs/numerical-validation.md`. Existing kernel verification log (scope limited to the named checks):

```
mkdir -p build
g++ -O3 -std=c++17 -Wall -Wextra -Wpedantic -Isrc tests/finite_volume.cpp -o build/finite_volume_test
./build/finite_volume_test
lake_at_rest_max_error 6.75848e-15
shared_face_water_sediment_conservation pass
analytical_settling_and_mass_conservation pass
dry_interface pass
```

Interpretation of production conservation and sensitivity remains pending. Finite residuals alone do not establish negligible budget drift. The final assessment requires maximum and terminal residuals with stated normalization, together with the numerical field differences and diagnostic changes from grid, time-step, and physical-assumption cases. Per-flood budget summaries precede migration and aggradation; the final summary row therefore excludes the last remap retained in the checkpoint. The planned sensitivity cases cover the first flood and retain 250 m channel spacing, so they cannot establish 580-flood migration or grid independence.

4 Independent figures and comparison targets

Figures 1–3 reserve all manuscript panels. A placeholder is a missing result. A generated panel must retain the configuration, sampling time, and plotted-data provenance in Appendix A. Status is assessed separately from whether a plotting script produced a file: a valid numerical panel may still disagree with the publication.

4.1 Flood deposits: manuscript panels 1A–F

The published comparison is between deposits from individual floods, not accumulated bed elevation. Panels 1A–D use $A = 0$, $C = 0.003$, and the default load at floods 61, 251, 501, and 562. Panels 1E and 1F use flood 562, with $(A, C) = (0.036, 0.003)$ and $(0, 0.0003)$, respectively. The published color scale spans 0–0.5 m, with deposits below 10^{-6} m distinguished from the active channel. This scale is a comparison reference, not a clipping rule for the computed mass budget.

The paper reports early splay deposition near migrating bend apices, progressive widening of the channel belt, and later deposition along abandoned channels. It reports reduced floodplain inundation

as channel depth increases, with event-to-event fluctuations under identical imposed floods. The high-aggradation and lower-load cases retain more widespread inundation. Independent comparison should measure deposit area above 10^{-6} m, deposit volume, transverse spread, channel sinuosity, and abandoned-channel coverage where saved output supports these diagnostics. No pixel-wise match is expected without the undocumented initial migration perturbation and dimensional migration parameters.

4.2 Transverse elevation: manuscript panels 2A–D

The cross-section uses the downstream one of the two saved grid columns equidistant from the domain midpoint, at 36.125 km for the 250 m grid. Its initial floodplain elevation is 3.5875 m under the model datum. Each panel requests elevations at the end of floods 50, 225, 400, and 580, before migration and aggradation. The published panels show a growing ridge with a concave cross-sectional envelope, interrupted by active and abandoned channels. The approximate late-time ridge elevations visible in the published panels are 40–45 m (2A), 25–30 m (2B), 15–17 m (2C), and 30–33 m (2D). These are coarse visual ranges, not digitized observations. The initial mid-domain floodplain is plotted near 9 m in the publication; DR1 leaves the absolute vertical datum unspecified. The independent plots apply no datum shift. Quantitative comparisons subtract each initial plane and retain the uncertainty of the published visual range. Channel minima, ridge width, and the sign and scale of relief growth provide additional comparisons.

4.3 Super-elevation and connectivity: manuscript panels 3A–C

Panel 3A requires one late-time β value for each of the 31 configurations. The paper reports that β rises with A and, over most shared A values, decreases with increasing C. A finer load reduces ridge super-elevation. The prose reports approximately a 15% increase in β for lower erodibility and a 6.5% decrease for higher erodibility; these are comparisons to test, not coefficients to impose. Only one of the fine-load simulations has published $\beta > 1$. The $\beta = 1$ line is an interpreted topographic threshold, not a modeled avulsion criterion.

Panel 3B compares α_n for $C = 0.0003$, 0.003, and 0.01 at $A = 0.018$ m per flood. The paper reports stronger temporal variability and higher peaks as sediment load increases. The published axis spans approximately 0.1–10 m; exact event timing is not identifiable from the written specification. Panel 3C compares α_{95} across all runs. The main reported pattern is large values for high suspended load and low aggradation, when conveyance occurs through localized breaches. Numerical comparison should report the computed ranges, trend signs, late-time variability, and any failure to preserve this ordering. A high α by itself does not demonstrate avulsion.

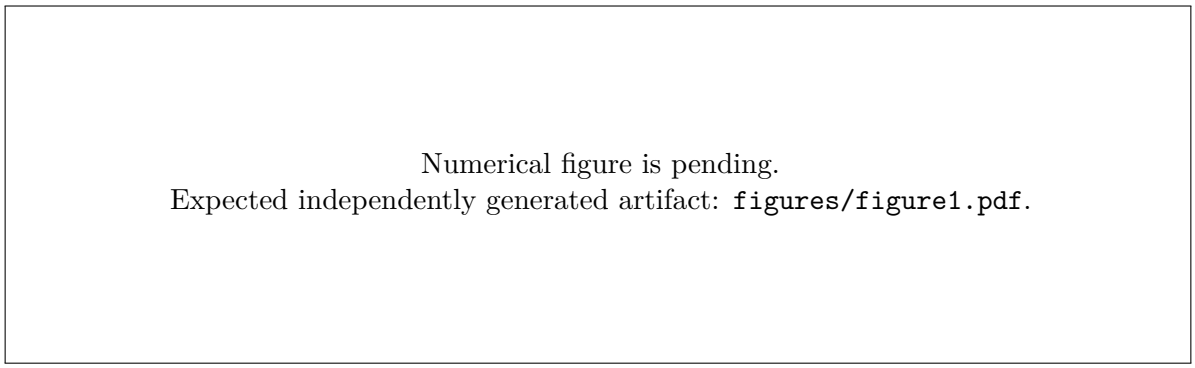


Figure 1: Independent model output for manuscript panels 1A–F: deposit thickness during each listed flood, in meters, on the 48 km by 72 km domain. A–D use $A = 0$, $C = 0.003$, $E = 1$, and the default grain mixture, at floods 61, 251, 501, and 562. E uses $A = 0.036$ and $C = 0.003$ at flood 562; F uses $A = 0$ and $C = 0.0003$ at flood 562. Flow is toward increasing downstream distance. Black marks active channel cells and green marks deposits below 10^{-6} m. The color scale extends to 0.5 m; larger values saturate visually but remain in the saved data and deposit-volume calculation. The solid magenta line in E follows the full active channel–floodplain interface used for the connectivity calculation, not its inundated subset. Snapshots precede each flood's migration and aggradation. These panels test whether levee breaches and abandoned channels focus deposition as the ridge grows. The panel ledger gives the status and commands for each requested result.

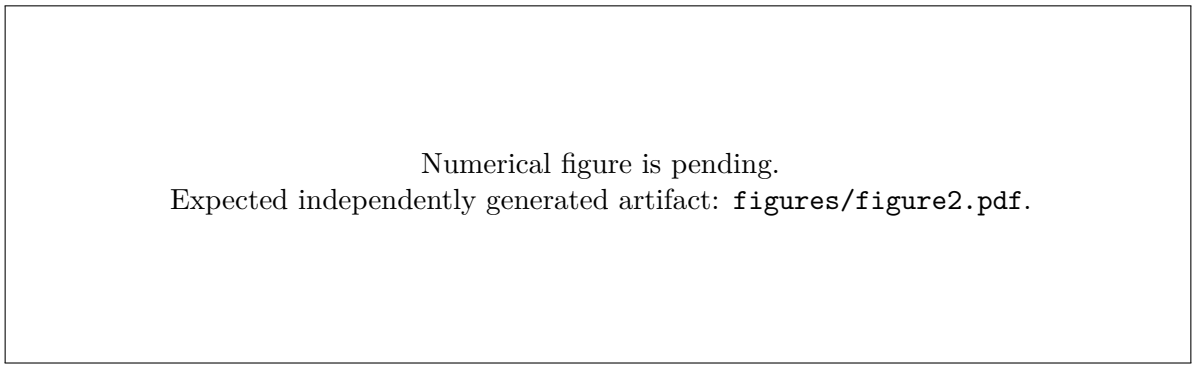


Figure 2: Independent model output for manuscript panels 2A–D: floodplain elevation versus transverse distance at the central grid column, 36.125 km downstream, at the end of floods 50, 225, 400, and 580, before migration and aggradation. Black solid, gray dotted, orange dashed, and red solid lines identify those floods, respectively. Cyan marks saved active channel-bed cells at flood 580. All cases use $E = 1$ and the default grain mixture. A: $A = 0.036$, $C = 0.01$; B: $A = 0.036$, $C = 0.0003$; C: $A = 0$, $C = 0.0003$; D: $A = 0.018$, $C = 0.003$. Aggradation A is in m per flood. Distance and elevation are in km and m, respectively. The initial section is at 3.5875 m; no datum shift is applied. The comparison tests ridge relief growth and channel deepening under different balances of prescribed bed aggradation and computed overbank deposition.

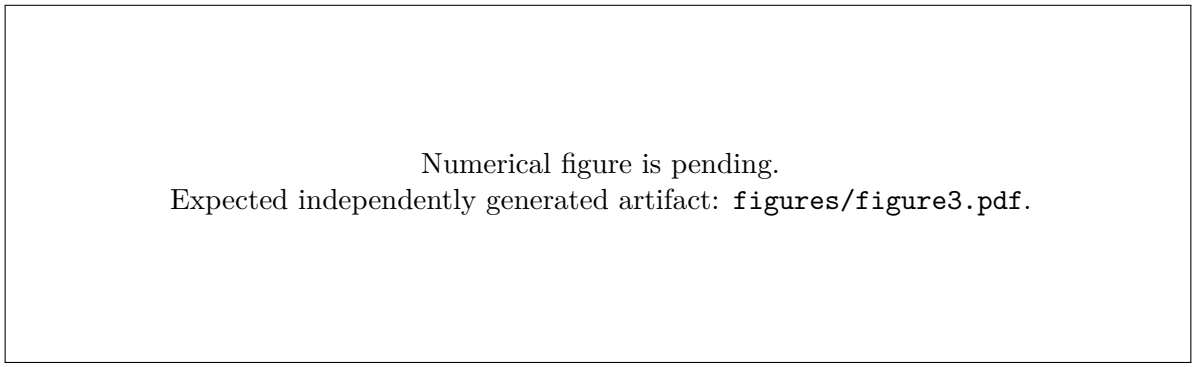


Figure 3: Independent model output for manuscript panels 3A–C. A: arithmetic mean of the per-flood super-elevation ratios β_n over floods 561–580, against imposed bed aggradation A, for all 31 configurations. B: connectivity α at day 12 of each flood for $A = 0.018$ m per flood and $C = 0.0003$, 0.003, and 0.01, with default load and $E = 1$. C: linearly interpolated 95th percentile of α over all 200 floods 381–580 against A. β is dimensionless; α and α_{95} are in meters. Purple, blue, orange, and black identify $C = 0.00003$, 0.0003, 0.003, and 0.01, respectively. Squares denote default load with $E = 1$, diamonds denote fine load, and plus and cross symbols denote $E = 0.5$ and 1.5. Red rings mark altered or unverified settings or incomplete histories. The dashed line at $\beta = 1$ is a published interpretive reference. Missing values create gaps; an incomplete or nonfinite statistical window yields no point. Alpha axes are logarithmic when all available values are positive. The panel ledger records current coverage and provenance.

4.4 Quantitative comparison status

0 of 29 specified numerical comparisons have complete, documented input records. Quantitative manuscript comparison remains pending. No agreement is inferred from missing windows, altered benchmark configurations, or the published axis limits.

The remaining 29 comparisons are pending. Exact required runs and reasons are recorded in `comparison.json`; no pending calculation is assigned a numerical result.

Plot provenance needs regeneration: plot_manifest.json missing; run scripts/plot.py first; metrics.csv missing; deposit_metrics.csv missing.

Published result columns were not read by this comparison. Relative erodibility changes use equally weighted paired cases; alpha variability uses the population coefficient of variation over floods 381–580. Datum comparisons subtract the initial plane and retain the uncertainty of coarse visual estimates.

5 Limits of the reconstruction

Assessment of the generated morphology remains pending. The automatic comparisons report scalar spatial scales, trend signs, and variability, but do not establish splay formation, abandoned-channel infilling, ridge concavity, or breach localization. Those claims require direct assessment of the independent maps and profiles and an authored record for each panel. Deposit footprint is not inundation extent. Per-flood alpha components and cutoff counts support temporal comparisons, subject to the missing day-12 rasters and undocumented initial migration perturbations. Completion of all numerical windows therefore does not, by itself, establish scientific reproduction.

The largest identifiable ambiguities concern the sediment concentration units, grain diameters and settling closures, flow resistance, the hydrograph shape, and the dimensional migration scale. These choices change sediment delivery, bankfull capacity, and the time needed to widen the channel belt. Their effects can therefore propagate into every panel. The definitions of ridge height and inundated interface add uncertainty to β and α even when the underlying hydraulic solution is unchanged. Assumption sensitivity must be separated from numerical resolution sensitivity.

The written model fixes channel width and bed aggradation. It does not resolve the bedload supply required to sustain the imposed bed elevation changes. Comparisons consequently concern alluvial ridge construction and connectivity within that idealization. Inferences about natural avulsion likelihood remain bounded by those assumptions.

6 Rebuild and deliverables

Not yet available. A verified clean model-to-report rebuild remains pending. To rebuild this report from the current ledger and figures, run `bash report/build.sh` from the repository root. That command does not run missing simulations and does not establish a completed reconstruction.

A Figure-by-figure record

The record is generated from `docs/panels.csv`. Every numerical panel requires both a data command and a plot command. “Not reproduced” includes unattempted or failed computations; “partially

reproduced" must name the missing sampling, physics, resolution, or agreement; "independently reproduced" is reserved for a documented panel whose plotted values come from this implementation. A schematic cannot satisfy a numerical panel.

Panel 1A

Quantity: individual-flood deposit thickness

Configuration: A=0 C=0.003 E=1 default

Sampling: flood 61

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 11 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 1B

Quantity: individual-flood deposit thickness

Configuration: A=0 C=0.003 E=1 default

Sampling: flood 251

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 11 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is

available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 1C

Quantity: individual-flood deposit thickness

Configuration: A=0 C=0.003 E=1 default

Sampling: flood 501

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 11 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 1D

Quantity: individual-flood deposit thickness

Configuration: A=0 C=0.003 E=1 default

Sampling: flood 562

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 11 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns;

docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 1E

Quantity: individual-flood deposit thickness and interface

Configuration: A=0.036 C=0.003 E=1 default

Sampling: flood 562

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 17 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 1F

Quantity: individual-flood deposit thickness

Configuration: A=0 C=0.0003 E=1 default

Sampling: flood 562

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 3 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 2A

Quantity: mid-domain floodplain cross-section elevation

Configuration: A=0.036 C=0.01 E=1 default

Sampling: floods 50 225 400 580

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 22 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 2B

Quantity: mid-domain floodplain cross-section elevation

Configuration: A=0.036 C=0.0003 E=1 default

Sampling: floods 50 225 400 580

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 10 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 2C

Quantity: mid-domain floodplain cross-section elevation

Configuration: A=0 C=0.0003 E=1 default

Sampling: floods 50 225 400 580

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 3 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 2D

Quantity: mid-domain floodplain cross-section elevation

Configuration: A=0.018 C=0.003 E=1 default

Sampling: floods 50 225 400 580

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 15 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 3A

Quantity: beta versus aggradation

Configuration: all 31 configurations

Sampling: last 20 floods

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs all -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 3B

Quantity: alpha time series

Configuration: A=0.018 C=0.0003/0.003/0.01 E=1 default

Sampling: 0.6 duration each flood

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs 7,15,20 -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

Panel 3C

Quantity: alpha95 versus aggradation

Configuration: all 31 configurations

Sampling: last 200 floods

Status: not reproduced

Data command:

```
python3 scripts/run_suite.py -runs all -floods 580 -data-root data
```

Plot command:

```
python3 scripts/plot.py -data-root data -output figures
```

Documentation: Nicholas et al. (2018), manuscript figure caption; DR1; DR2 configuration columns; docs/implementation.md

Assessment: No requested numerical data are verified for this panel.

Data coverage: current plotted-data verification unavailable. No current plotter coverage record is available.

Data provenance: plot input hashes unavailable; no numerical source files recorded. Coverage claims have not been verified against unchanged numerical inputs.

Source ledger status: not reproduced

Source ledger notes: Coupled implementation and plotting script available; required production outputs pending. Commands are from repository root; see docs/rebuild.md for the clean workflow.

B Configuration matrix

This table contains input parameters only. It is generated from `config/runs.csv`, transcribed from the configuration columns of DR2 [2]. A is in m per flood. Units for the published C are unspecified. All runs require 580 floods at the documented resolution.

Run	A	C	E	Load
1	0	3e-05	1	fine
2	0	3e-05	1	default
3	0	0.0003	1	default
4	0.004	0.0003	1	default
5	0.008	0.0003	1	default
6	0.012	0.0003	1	default
7	0.018	0.0003	1	default
8	0.026	0.0003	1	default
9	0.031	0.0003	1	default
10	0.036	0.0003	1	default
11	0	0.003	1	default
12	0.004	0.003	1	default
13	0.008	0.003	1	default
14	0.012	0.003	1	default
15	0.018	0.003	1	default
16	0.026	0.003	1	default
17	0.036	0.003	1	default
18	0.004	0.01	1	default
19	0.012	0.01	1	default
20	0.018	0.01	1	default
21	0.026	0.01	1	default
22	0.036	0.01	1	default
23	0	0.003	1	fine
24	0.008	0.003	1	fine
25	0.018	0.003	1	fine
26	0.036	0.003	1	fine
27	0	0.0003	0.5	default
28	0	0.0003	1.5	default
29	0.012	0.0003	0.5	default
30	0.012	0.0003	1.5	default
31	0	0.0003	1	fine

References

[1] Nicholas, A. P., Aalto, R. E., Sambrook Smith, G. H., and Schwendel, A. C. (2018). Hydrodynamic controls on alluvial ridge construction and avulsion likelihood in meandering river floodplains. *Geology*, 46, 639–642. https://doi.org/10.1130/G40104.1.

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